IELTS FOUNDATION · UNIT 7

Jobs, Work and Study

Your skills, your abilities and your first summer job

Vocabulary | Grammar | Reading | Listening | Writing | Speaking

Mindset for IELTS Foundation · Unit 7 · Book pp. 80–91

LEARNING GOAL

Talk and write about your skills and abilities, and apply for a summer job

Objectives: you will…

- use words for jobs, work, study and work experience
- use words for skills and abilities
- scan for specific information
- use can / can’t and could / couldn’t
- speak about your skills and abilities
- write an email in reply to a job advert

Success criteria: I can…

- predict the missing information before I listen
- write numbers as figures (16, not sixteen)
- use can for now and could for the past
- tell the difference between False and Not Given
- give reasons and examples when I speak
- answer every point of the advert in 60–80 words

IELTS STRATEGIES

Test habits to build in this unit

LISTENING

Predict the missing information. Write numbers as **figures**.

Tip 04, p. 81

SPEAKING

No short answers. Give **reasons** (because) and **examples** (for example, like).

box, p. 83

READING

Skim first for the main ideas.

Tip 14, p. 84

READING

T / F / NG: key words, **synonyms**. Not in the text = **Not Given**.

Exam strategy and Tip 15, p. 86

LEAD-IN

What are they doing?

- helping the elderly
- wearing a uniform
- meeting
- studying

Which of these do you do? What job would you like one day?

VOCABULARY

Skills and abilities

write well · read a map · play sport well · do well in exams · understand maths easily

talk to new people easily · speak many languages · cook many types of food · work long hours · remember a lot of information

Tell a partner: “I’m good at … but I’m not good at …”

LISTENING · NOTE COMPLETION

Predict before you listen

Day: _____ → a day

Time: _____ → a time

Left school at the age of _____ → an age

Got a job in a _____ restaurant → an adjective

IELTS STRATEGY

Predict which information could be missing: **numbers** (dates, times, years, ages) or **words** (nouns, names, adjectives).

Write the **figure**: 4, not four.

GRAMMAR · FORM AND USE

can / can’t · could / couldn’t

	Now (present ability)	Past ability
Able to	I **can** speak Thai.	I **could** swim when I was five.
Not able to	I **can’t** (cannot) drive.	I **couldn’t** (could not) read maps.
Questions	**Can** you read a map?	What sports **could** you play?



can / could + **base verb**: not “can to swim”, “she cans”, “couldn’t rode”.

GRAMMAR · PRACTICE

Then and now

1 When I was six, I _____ ride a bike, so I walked to school.

2 I _____ speak French, but I'd like to learn.

3 _____ you cook when you were ten?

4 My grandmother is 80, but she _____ still swim very well.

Now write two true sentences about you: one with **couldn't … but now I can**.

GRAMMAR · COMMON MISTAKES

Find the mistake

× Mistake	✓ Correct	Why
I **can to** swim.	I **can** swim.	no to after can
She **cans** speak French.	She **can** speak French.	can never takes -s
I couldn’t **rode** a bike.	I couldn’t **ride** a bike.	base verb after could
When I was five, I **can** read.	When I was five, I **could** read.	past ability: could
Do you can cook?	**Can you** cook?	question: Can + you

Find the mistake, say the rule, then write the correct sentence.

SPEAKING · SKILLS AND ABILITIES

Don’t stop at one sentence

SHORT

“I can cook.”

LONGER

“I can cook quite well **because** my mum taught me. I can make lots of dishes, **like** green curry and fried rice. When I was younger, I **couldn’t** cook anything!”

IELTS STRATEGY Give **reasons** with because and **examples** with for example / like.

VOCABULARY · WORK EXPERIENCE

Summer jobs and work words

Jobs

lifeguard · sales assistant · sports coach · receptionist · waiter · chef · cleaner · video game designer

Work and study

take / pass / fail an exam · start / finish a course · get a job · work long hours · **at** work · **on** Monday · **in** a restaurant

Which summer job would suit you? Why?

READING · SKIMMING

Two minutes: what is it about?

Read **only**: the title · the first lines · the headings

Don’t stop at new words.

Then answer: **Why** get a summer job? **How many** types of job?

IELTS STRATEGY

Reading the text quickly (**skimming**) helps you understand the main ideas.

READING · TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN

Same, opposite or missing?

“Cafés need extra staff in the summer. You don’t need experience, but you must be friendly.”

Café workers should be **kind to people**.
True: friendly = kind

You need **experience** to work in a café.
False: opposite

Café workers **earn a lot** in summer.
Not Given: no information

IELTS STRATEGY Highlight key words · find the paragraph · scan for **synonyms** · not mentioned = **Not Given**

WRITING · AN EMAIL FOR A SUMMER JOB

Three points, nothing extra

1 · Which job?
I’m interested in the … job.

2 · Your skills
I can … I’m good at …

3 · Then and now
I couldn’t …, but now I can.

Greeting · separate paragraphs · polite ending + name · **60–80 words**

WRITING · MODEL

A model email (about 70 words)

Dear Simon,

I’m interested in the holiday club helper job.

I think I have the right skills. I **can** play the guitar and I **can** draw well, so I **can** do fun activities with children. I am also very patient.

When I was younger, I **couldn’t** talk to new people easily, but now I **can**, because I joined a drama club at school.

Thanks,
Mai

PAIR PRACTICE

Your turn, together

Student A

Ask: What can you do well? What couldn’t you do when you were younger? What job would you like?

Student B

Ask: What skill do you want to learn? Can you speak another language? What summer job would suit you?

Answer with a reason (because) and an example (for example / like). No short answers!

REVIEW

Can you…?

- ✓ name jobs, skills and abilities
- ✓ predict missing information before you listen
- ✓ use can / can’t and could / couldn’t
- ✓ skim an article for the main ideas
- ✓ tell True, False and Not Given apart
- ✓ write a 60–80 word job email

Next: the Unit 7 Challenge on the Miss L Gems site.